McBidAsk recalc-on-load and daily tick chunking: implementation spec

Repo: ettiennehugo/MultiCharts.Net. **Base:** `origin/main` 33a51bf (merge of PR #76). All line numbers refer to that commit. **Scope:** two fixes in one new PR, kept apart from every other branch (see the coder brief). PriceAction is not touched. **Author:** Grok Bot (spec only, no code). **Status:** draft for Ettienne. Nine API points (P-RC1..P-RC9) were open. The `_McApiDump2` output answered P-RC5, P-RC6, P-RC8 and P-RC9, and the `_McRecalcProbe` run (2026-11-01, historical @ES 1-min, `realTime(False)`, `autoTrading(False)`) answered P-RC1, P-RC2, P-RC3, P-RC4 and P-RC7 (§8). All nine passed, so the defaults stand (event-driven recalc primary, `McRecalcFromCallback = false`). P-RC-EResolution is answered by Ettienne's `EResolution` dump (2026-11-01 15:56): the exact time-based set is Second/Minute/Hour/Day (§7.3).

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1. Evidence (log 01M6C29N9KQHKWP9Z2V017GD3Q.csv, runs 180c9976 and f625f122, @ES 1-min, chart 2026-08-31 → 2026-09-18)

Observation	Log line(s)	Cause
`OF McBidAsk diag request ... chartType(Regular) from(2026-08-30 17:02) to(2026-11-02 12:19)`	97	The request `To` is `DateTime.Now+1d`, which is 6 weeks past the chart's last bar. `chartType` prints `Regular` even though `CreateFootPrint` was used (§7.1).
`OF T9 session(..) bars(13xx) mcCover(0.0)` and `OF tier McBidAsk->Unavailable reason(missing)` for every session	100–126	The McBidAsk history arrives only after the backtest has passed all bars (see the next row).
B: `RUN-END ... 16:00` comes first, then `history done batches(1) data2Bars(61837) levels(479517)`	85–92	The loader finishes after the last bar, so the levels are never used. Nothing triggers a second pass.
B: 3× `OF tick loader callback exception(System.ApplicationException) message(Array dimensions exceeded supported range.)`	86–88	Each of the Trade/Bid/Ask 1-tick requests covers 2026-08-30 → 2026-11-02 (~45 Globex days of ES ticks), which is more than one .NET array can hold. All tick history is lost.
C (f625f122): **no** callback, exception, `history done` or `stop` lines after RUN-END (the last lines are 128–130)	–	The queued callback lines drain only in `CalcBar`/`StopCalc` (`_VolumeProfileFuturesBase.Strategy.CS` 138–145, 627–639). A finished historical chart gets no new bar, so the lines sit in the queue until the study is removed. The log cannot show whether run C's callbacks have fired.
`OF MaxBars cap 5000 hit at bar 5051`	107	See §7.4.

2. MC .NET API facts used (with sources)

Fact	Source
`IStudy.ExecControl` is `ICalculationControl` and "allows the user to interrupt the calculation, recalculate the study, or force the study to calculate over a given period of time".	PLStudiesProxy metadata (`specs/mc-portfolio-api.txt` l.176); PG v1.0 §4.1.2 (l.690)
`ExecControl.Recalculate()` restarts the study from `StartCalc` and then runs `CalcBar` over all bars. Statements after it in the same method do not run, so it unwinds the stack. Calling it unconditionally loops forever, so it needs a persistent guard.	PG VolumeProfile section, txt l.3616/3700 (`this.ExecControl.Recalculate()` from the `EChanged` handler); MC wiki RecalcLastBarAfter / Recalculate; forum (recalc guard via persistent vars)
`StartCalc` "can be called repeatedly during the object's life cycle". `Create` runs once. The object instance is reused, so **plain C# fields survive a Recalculate** unless `StartCalc`/`StopCalc` reset them.	PG §4.1.2; MC wiki How Indicators and Signals are Calculated
MC uses internal exceptions for its own control flow (MaxBarsBack restart). Foreign exceptions must not be caught.	MC wiki (same page)

Fact	Source
`ExecControl.RecalcLastBarAfter(TimeSpan)` makes MC call `protected override void OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent()` after the timeout, **even when no ticks arrive**. It does not recalculate by itself.	MC wiki; forum t=43339 (indicators). Probe P-RC2: also fires on a **signal** on a historical (non-RT) chart, about 1.0 s after `RecalcLastBarAfter(1 s)` was armed at the last bar; forum t=49867 ("does not run when backtesting") does not apply to chart backtesting. The repo already calls it from a signal: `_CustomSignal.Strategy.CS` 2068.
DataLoader callbacks run on a separate thread. `Bars`, `Output`, `trace()` and `engineSink` belong to the calc thread only.	PG §4.7.4; repo comment 712–713; probe P-RC7: a callback (tid 61) arrived while `CalcBar` (tid 60) slept in a wait loop (done in 52 ms)
The same study object (and its instance fields) is kept across `Recalculate()`.	Probe P-RC1: `obj(719710)` on both passes; `instRecalcs=1` carried into pass 2
`OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent` runs on the calc thread, and `Bars.Time[0]` is readable in it.	Probe P-RC3: tid 60, the same as `CalcBar`
`Recalculate()` called from `OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent` does not return: it throws `ManagedStudies.details._ELAPI_exception_Wrap_`, MC's unwind, and `StopCalc` then `StartCalc` (pass 2) follow at once. It must propagate (last statement, never caught); code after `base.CalcBar()` in a derived strategy does not run on that path.	Probe P-RC4
`StopCalc` runs on the UI thread (tid 1), **not** the calc thread. Nothing reached from `StopCalc` may read `Bars`, `Output` or other calc-thread-only API; trace lines there are stamped with the bar time cached on the calc thread.	Probe (2026-11-01), StopCalc line
`InstrumentDataRequest`: `Resolution`, `QuoteField`, `From`/`To` (the PG calls these "outdated, better to use Range"), `DataRequest Range`, `RequestTimeZone TimeZone` (Local/Exchange/GMT), `Subscribe2RT`. `Bars.Request` returns a copy of the chart's request (same feed, session and time zone).	PG §4.7.4 (l.2979–3045, 3083–3131)
`DataRequest.CreateFromTo(DateTime, DateTime)` is typed and static.	Already used in `_CheckData.Strategy.CS` 184
`Bars.FullSymbolData` indexes "from the current bar, leftwards with positive indices, and rightwards with negative ones", and `.Count` is the total bar count. The last chart bar is therefore `Time[Current - Count]`.	PG §4.1.2 (l.931–945)
Footprint levels need `Resolution.CreateFootPrint(EResolution, size, CumulativeDeltaChartType, FootPrintChartType, bool)`. Without it, `Data2` stays null.	Forum t=52737 (in code since #74); Data2 delivered 61837 bars in run B

Anything not in this table is unverified and is listed in §8. Of the §8 points, the API dump answered P-RC5, P-RC6, P-RC8 and P-RC9, and the probe answered P-RC1, P-RC2, P-RC3, P-RC4 and P-RC7.

3. Code map (origin/main 33a51bf)

`_VolumeProfileFuturesBase.Strategy.CS` - 127–136 `StartCalc`: calls `startOrderFlow()` (no trace possible here, per comment 135). - 138–145 `CalcBar`: `drainFlowQueue()` first, then `updateOrderFlow()`. - 589–609 config and fields: `FlowCfg` (protected `_OrderFlow.FlowConfig`), `McBidAskChartType` (606), `m_mc*` state. - 614–625 `startOrderFlow`: **ends all loads and resets every McBidAsk field, including `m_mcHistoryDone`. It also replaces `m_flow`, which is where the levels live.** A recalc therefore loses everything today. - 627–639 `StopCalc` and 641–648 `stopOrderFlowLoads` (`EndLoadData` on everything). - 650–673 `startFlowLoader`: the three whole-range 1-tick requests (662–664). **This is Fix 2's target.** - 677–698 `startMcLevelLoader`: the CreateFootPrint request; `To = Now+1d` at 689; the request diag line at 696. - 700–739: diag counters, `mcDiag`, the queue (`enqueueFlowMsg`, `queueSink`, `drainFlowQueue`). - 743–794 `onMcLevels`; 796–813 `mcSet` (writes only into `m_flow`); 816–841 `mcJournal`. - 844–865 `onFlowData` (the exception at 864 is the source of the three "Array dimensions" lines); 869–875 `flowTick`. - 877–921 `updateOrderFlow`: starts the loader on the first call (888). The all-or-nothing tick gate is at 910.

`_OrderFlow.Function.CS` (MC-free; the `// <order-flow>` block 30–519 is extracted by `tests/OrderFlowTests`) - 71–90 `FlowConfig` (`MaxBars = 5000` at 80). - 175–187 `Ev` and `Queue` (each stream must be pushed in time order). - 193–361 `FlowEngine`: `AddMcLevels` 226; `takeMc/applyMc` 234–270; **`CloseBar` 294–361 pops every queued trade with `Time <= CloseTime` into the current bar (301–319)**. See the backlog bug in §7.3.

`_CmeSessionClock.Function.CS`: `ToEastern` 142–154, `GlobexDate` 164, `GlobexTradingDayEt` 235, `IsGlobexClosedDay` 368, `DefaultHaltStart` 17:00 ET (58). `_CustomSignal.Strategy.CS`: logger `WriteTrace` (one `File.AppendAllText` per line under a lock) 110–125; `trace` ~360; `engineSink` 1831; RUN-END 2131–2139; `RecalcLastBarAfter` for account loading 2068. `tools/sem/stubs/McStubs.cs`: `IExecControl` has only `RecalcLastBarAfter` (57); `DataRequest` has no `CreateFromTo` (36); `InstrumentDataRequest` has no `TimeZone` (37).

4. Fix 1: cache the McBidAsk history and recalculate once on load

4.1 Pure parts (in the `<order-flow>` block, unit-tested)

- **`McLevelCache`** (sealed class):
- `SortedDictionary<DateTime, double[][]>` holding the same `{price, ask, bid}` triple as `AddMcLevels`.
- `string Signature`, `bool HistoryDone`, `DateTime First, Last`, `int Sets`, `long Levels`.
- `Add(DateTime, double[], double[], double[])`, `ReplayInto(FlowEngine)`, `Clear()`.
- `bool Covers(DateTime from, DateTime to)` (HistoryDone && First ≤ from+1 bar && Last ≥ to−1 bar).
- **`McRecalcGate`** (sealed class, no MC types). Fields: `int RecalcCount`, `string RecalcSignature`, `int MissedBeforeDone`, `DateTime MissedFirst/MissedLast`, `int Pass`.
- `NoteMissed(DateTime)`.
- `Decide(bool historyDone, bool cacheCoversMissed, bool autoTrading, bool enabled, int max, string sig)` returns a typed `enum RecalcDecision { Wait, Recalc, SkipNoMissed, SkipGuard, SkipAutoTrading, SkipDisabled }`.
- The guard: `RecalcCount < max` **for this signature**. If a pass 2 request ever re-fired its history, `SkipGuard` stops a second recalc.
- `Forget()` sets `RecalcSignature = null; RecalcCount = 0` (missed-bar counters and `Pass` are kept). It is called on a **signature** cache miss (§4.3), see "Gate reset" below.
- `SkipLine(d, sig, max)` builds the skip journal line of §4.4 (reason, `recalcCount(CountFor(sig)/max)`, `recalcSig(RecalcSignature|none)`).
- **`McLevelCache.Miss(sig, from, to)`** returns a typed repo enum `McCacheMiss { None, Empty, Signature, Incomplete, Coverage }`; `MissName` gives the journal text and `MissReason` (string) wraps the two. A cache that holds **another** request's signature is a `Signature` miss even when it holds no level set (checked before `Empty`).
- **Gate reset (A → B → A, Live Check 9a rerun).** The gate is per object and used to keep one signature for its lifetime, so A (recalc) → B (no recalc, e.g. `noMissedBars`) → A refused the recalc for the fresh A download with `SkipGuard`. Now a `Signature` miss calls `m_mcGate.Forget()` under `m_flowLock` (only when the gate holds a signature; the miss line then ends `recalcGate(reset)`). A real recalc loop comes back with the **same** signature (a hit, or an `incomplete`/`coverage` miss), so it never reaches `Forget`; the static process-wide `McRecalcLoopGuard` (`McRecalcGuardMaxPerKey` = 3 per `McRecalcGuardWindowSec` = 600 per key) stays the backstop, also for a fast A ↔ B alternation.

4.2 Field lifetime (the core of the fix)

- Add `private readonly McLevelCache m_mcCache = new McLevelCache();` and `private readonly McRecalcGate m_mcGate = new McRecalcGate();` to `_VolumeProfileFuturesBase`, next to 607–609.
- **`startOrderFlow` (614–625) must not clear either of them.**
- `StopCalc` (627–639) does not clear them either. It still ends the loads.
- They are cleared only when the signature no longer matches (§4.3), so a user-driven reload with a different symbol, resolution or chart start starts clean.
- P-RC1 (§8) confirms that the instance survives `Recalculate`.

- If the probe shows MC re-creates the object instead, the fallback is a `static Dictionary<string, McLevelCache>` keyed by signature and process-local. It holds the last 2 signatures at most.

4.3 Flow

1. **First CalcBar, at the point where `startFlowLoader` runs today (888).** Build the signature on the calc thread: `Bars.Info.Name | Bars.Info.DataFeed | res.Type | res.Size | McBidAskChartType | FlowCfg.McBidAsk | firstBarTime`. Compute `lastBarTime = Bars.FullSymbolData.Time[Current - Count]`. - **Hit** when `Signature == sig && m_mcCache.Covers(firstBarTime, lastBarTime)`:
   - Call `m_mcCache.ReplayInto(m_flow)` under `m_flowLock`.
   - Set `m_mcHistoryDone = true`, `m_mcLoaded = Sets`, `m_mcFirst/Last`.
   - **Do not call `startMcLevelLoader`**, except on a live chart (`Environment.IsRealTimeCalc` or `lastBarTime` ≥ Now−1 day), which gets a tail request instead: `Range = DataRequest.CreateFromTo(m_mcCache.Last, Now+1d)`, `Subscribe2RT = true`. It covers RT and the bars since the cache was filled and is logged as `request(tail)`.
   - Log `cache hit` and `recalc pass using cache`.
   - **Miss** (any other case): on a typed `McCacheMiss.Signature` miss with `m_mcGate.RecalcSignature != null`, `m_mcGate.Forget()` (§4.1 gate reset); then `m_mcCache.Clear(); m_mcCache.Signature = sig` (all under `m_flowLock`), log `cache miss reason(..)`, and issue the normal request (with the `To` clamp of §4.5).
2. **Callback (`onMcLevels` 743–794, `mcSet` 796–813).** `mcSet` writes each set into `m_mcCache` **and** into `m_flow` (under `m_flowLock`, which is already held). When History is completed: `m_mcCache.HistoryDone = true` (next to 790). Only state is set; **no MC call from this thread**.
3. **`mcJournal` (816–841).** When `fp.McMiss == "missing" && !m_mcHistoryDone`, call `m_mcGate.NoteMissed(fp.CloseTime)` to count the pass-1 bars that would have used McBidAsk.
4. **Trigger. This runs on the calc thread only and is factored into `private void mcRecalcCheck(string from)`.** It is called at the end of `CalcBar` (after `updateOrderFlow`) and from `OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent`. - When `m_mcHistoryDone && m_mcGate.Decide(...) == Recalc`:
   - Log `recalc triggered`, then `drainFlowQueue()`.
   - Set `m_mcGate.RecalcCount++; m_mcGate.RecalcSignature = sig`.
   - **Then `ExecControl.Recalculate();` as the last statement, not inside any `try/catch`** (it unwinds; see §2).
   - `cacheCoversMissed` = `m_mcCache.First ≤ MissedLast && m_mcCache.Last ≥ MissedFirst`.
   - `SkipNoMissed` means the history arrived before any bar needed it, so no recalc is needed.
   - `SkipAutoTrading`: never auto-recalc while `Environment.IsAutoTradingMode`, because orders would be re-evaluated. Log the skip once.
5. **Idle poll.** This is what makes the trigger, and the log drain, work with no new bar. - In `CalcBar`, when `Bars.LastBarOnChart && Bars.Status == EBarState.Close` and either (a) `m_mcStarted && !m_mcHistoryDone`, or (b) the flow queue is non-empty, or (c) a tick chunk is pending (Fix 2):
   - call `ExecControl.RecalcLastBarAfter(TimeSpan.FromMilliseconds(FlowCfg.McIdlePollMs))` once;
   - set `m_idleArmed = true`;
   - log `idle poll armed` once.
   - New override in `_VolumeProfileFuturesBase`: `protected override void OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent() { base.OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent(); // keep whatever the base does (_CustomSignal arms it for account loading, 2068) drainFlowQueue(); pumpTickChunks(); // Fix 2 if (mcRecalcDecision() == RecalcDecision.Recalc) { mcRecalcNow("idle"); return; } // mcRecalcNow ends with ExecControl.Recalculate() if (!idleWorkPending()) return; if ((DateTime.Now - m_idleSince).TotalSeconds < FlowCfg.McIdleTimeoutSec) ExecControl.RecalcLastBarAfter(TimeSpan.FromMilliseconds(FlowCfg.McIdlePollMs)); else logOnce("OF McBidAsk idle poll timeout ..."); }`
   - `drainFlowQueue` stamps lines through `trace()` with `Bars.Time[0]`. This is legal only if the event runs in calc context (P-RC3).
6. **Fallback if P-RC2/P-RC3 fail** (they passed, so this stays off by default) (the event does not fire on a historical signal, or `Bars` is not accessible in it). Add `FlowCfg.McRecalcFromCallback = false`. When it is `true`, the history-completed branch of `onMcLevels` calls `ExecControl.Recalculate()` directly once, guarded by the gate. The precedent is the PG VolumeProfile `EChanged` handler (txt

l.3616) and the repo's `_VolumeProfileStatistics.Indicator.CS` 357. - The queued lines then get a direct-write path: snapshot `Bars.Time[0]`, the zone label and `RunId` in each `CalcBar` into volatile fields, and add a protected `_CustomSignal.traceAt(ETraceLevel, DateTime stamp, string msg)` (the logger is private, at 62) that callbacks call with the snapshot. That is still one `File.AppendAllText` per line. Mark these lines with `async(1)`. - Ship this path disabled. The probe decides the default.

4.4 Diag lines (Journal; prefix `OF McBidAsk`, so the `_VolumeProfileBaseLog` parsers keep working)

```
OF McBidAsk cache miss reason(empty|signature|incomplete|coverage) sig(<sig>) [recalcGate(reset)]
OF McBidAsk cache stored sets(N) levels(L) first(yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm) last(..) sig(<sig>)
(calc thread, once after historyDone)
OF McBidAsk cache hit sets(N) levels(L) first(..) last(..) pass(P) request(none|tail from(..))
OF McBidAsk recalc triggered from(bar|idle|callback) pass(P) missedBars(M) missedFirst(..)
missedLast(..) recalcCount(1/1)
OF McBidAsk recalc pass using cache pass(P) recalcCount(1)
OF McBidAsk recalc skipped reason(noMissedBars|guard|autoTrading|disabled) recalcCount(n/
McRecalcMax) recalcSig(<sig>|none)   (once per pass)
OF McBidAsk recalc skipped reason(processGuard) maxPerKey(3) windowSec(600) key(<key>)
OF McBidAsk idle poll armed ms(1000)   /   OF McBidAsk idle poll timeout sec(900)
historyDone(False) chunksPending(n)
```

`recalcCount/recalcSig` are read under `m_flowLock` with the decision: `reason(guard) recalcCount(1/1) recalcSig(<sig>)` is a previous recalc of this signature, `recalcCount(0/0) recalcSig(none)` is `McRecalcMax = 0`. `Pass` counts the `StartCalc` calls in the object's lifetime (a field that is never reset). The existing `RUN id(..)` line gets a new id per pass (CS-3, 2014), which is expected.

4.4a Bar total and Build Volume On (Live Check 9a volMismatch, Ettienne 2026-11-01)

- Evidence: after the cache pass every session logged `OF tier McBidAsk->Unavailable reason(volMismatch)` with `mcCover` ≈ 0.
- Cause: the bar total fed to `CloseBar` (and compared in `applyMc` against ask + bid) was `Bars.Volume[0]`. On intraday charts (tick, volume, time ≤ 24 h) MC's `Volume` is the **up** volume only; the total is `Bars.Ticks[0]` (MC wiki / PG §4.2: Volume, Ticks, UpTicks, DownTicks). The strategy now passes `Volume = Bars.Ticks[0]`, `UpTicks = Bars.UpTicks[0]`, `DownTicks = Bars.DownTicks[0]`; `_VolumeProfileBase`'s zero-volume check reads `Bars.Ticks[0]` too. VWAP/VP volume math is unchanged (a separate PR, after the diag confirms it).
- BarUpDown gate: `Up + Down == Ticks` on Trade Volume. Unchanged-price volume that MC does not book as up/down makes the bar not qualify (test BU2).
- Build Volume On: no typed MC member is confirmed (stubs, PG, wiki; `IInstrumentSettings` has none, IP-1.4). `FlowCfg.BuildVolumeOn` stays `Unknown` (existing behaviour) unless a derived strategy sets it. `_McApiDump4.Indicator.CS` (box only, not in the PR) dumps `Bars.Info`, `Bars.Info.Resolution`, `Bars.Request`, `Bars.Request.Resolution`, `ASymbolInfo2` and every volume-named enum, to be run once with Trade Volume and once with Tick Count.
- `FlowCfg.BuildVolumeOn = TickCount` (any category): McBidAsk is never compared; the tier is Unavailable `reason(volumeBasis)` (not `volMismatch`), logged once at **Info**: `OF McBidAsk Unavailable reason(volumeBasis): Build Volume On = Tick Count; footprint is contracts, bar total is tick count`. Tick Count is valid on non-futures charts: no Warning, no exception, the bar total is used as is.
- **Held until the dump confirms a typed member:** futures (`Bars.Info.Category == ESymbolCategory.Future`) + Tick Count logs an Error (per-line `File.AppendAllText`) and throws in `_VolumeProfileBase.StartCalc`: `Futures chart <symbol>: Build Volume On must be Trade Volume (Format Instrument > Settings); Tick Count counts trades, not contracts, so volume profiles, VWAP and order flow would be wrong.` `_VolumeProfileBase` is the narrowest common base: volume profiles and VWAP (`_VpVwapEngine`) live there and order flow is in its subclass `_VolumeProfileFuturesBase`; `_CustomSignal` would also hit non-volume strategies.

- Diag (Info, calc thread, built under `m_flowLock` and written after it via `trace()`): the first 10 closed bars and the first 10 `volMismatch` bars of each pass, counted apart:

```
OF McBidAsk diag vol bar(n) t(yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss) volume(Bars.Volume[0]) ticks(Bars.Ticks[0]) up(Bars.UpTicks[0]) down(Bars.DownTicks[0]) prevTicks(Bars.Ticks[1]|NaN) mcAsk(..) mcBid(..) mcSum(..) miss(missing|volMismatch|volumeBasis|none)
```

4.5 Request window clamp (applies to Fix 1 and Fix 2)

- Replace `To = DateTime.Now.AddDays(1)` (663, 689) with `lastBarTime.AddDays(1)`, where `lastBarTime` is as in §4.3.
- Set the range through `req.Range = DataRequest.CreateFromTo(from, to)` (typed, as in `_CheckData` 184), and also set `From`/`To` to the same values. P-RC5 (dump) confirmed these members: `Range` is a `DataRequest` field and `From`/`To` are properties. Setting both is harmless, so do it whichever one MC reads.
- On run B this cuts the McBidAsk load from 61837 to about 20k bars (14 Globex days × ~1380).

5. Fix 2: daily, session-aware tick chunks

5.1 Plan (pure, unit-tested; `<order-flow>` block)

- `static List<DayChunk> PlanGlobexDays(DateTime firstGx, DateTime lastGx, Func<DateTime, bool> closedDay, TimeSpan boundaryEt)` returns one `DayChunk { DateTime GlobexDate, FromEt, ToEt }` per Globex date that is not closed.
- Each window is `[GlobexDate−1 day + boundaryEt, GlobexDate + boundaryEt)`, with `boundaryEt = 17:00` (CME daily halt start, `_CmeSessionClock.DefaultHaltStart`), so no tick straddles two chunks. Monday's chunk starts Sunday 17:00 ET.
- `firstGx`/`lastGx` come from `clock().GlobexDate(firstBarTime / lastBarTime)`, and `closedDay` from `clock().IsGlobexClosedDay`.
- **Time zone.** The windows are built in ET and converted to the request zone with a new `public DateTime FromEastern(DateTime et)` on `_CmeSessionClock` (the inverse of `ToEastern` at 142; DST-aware; ambiguous → standard). The request keeps `Bars.Request`'s `TimeZone` (Exchange on 9a: CME, Central), so tick times and bar times share one zone. P-RC6 (dump): `InstrumentDataRequest` has a `RequestTimeZone TimeZone` field (`Local`, `GMT`, `Exchange`), so the copy from `Bars.Request` carries it. Log it typed in the request line.
- **`TickChunkScheduler`** (pure). Its state per (day, stream): `Pending → InFlight → Done | Failed | Skipped`.
- `Next(DateTime calcPosition)` yields up to `MaxInFlightDays` days (all streams of a day together).
- `Complete(day, stream, ok, count)` records the outcome.
- `ReleasableInOrder()` frees completed days strictly in day order per stream, because `FlowEngine.Queue` needs each stream in time order (177, 190). With `MaxInFlightDays = 1` (the default) the order is guaranteed and the release buffer is a no-op.

5.2 Requests (replace 650–667)

- For each chunk and stream (Trade, plus Bid/Ask when `QuotesExpected`):
- `req = Bars.Request; req.Resolution = new Resolution(EResolution.Tick, 1); req.QuoteField = field; req.Range = DataRequest.CreateFromTo(from, to)` (plus the same `From`/`To`).
- `req.Subscribe2RT = isLastChunk`.
- `state = chunkIndex * 3 + stream`, boxed `int` as today (848).
- **Issued only from the calc thread** by `pumpTickChunks()`, which is called in `updateOrderFlow` (replacing 888) and from `OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent`. BeginLoadData is never called from a callback; that is unverified, so it is not used.
- **Late days.** Under `FlowCfg.TickChunkLate == Skip` (the default), a day whose window ends before the last closed bar at issue time is marked `Skipped reason(late)` and not requested, because its ticks could no longer be used. The last chunk, which carries RT, is always requested.
- **Bounded wait mode** (`FlowCfg.TickChunkWaitMs > 0`; default 0 = off). This mode makes the tick tier usable in historical backtests. At the first bar of each Globex day, `CalcBar` waits up to `TickChunkWaitMs` for that day's chunks with `Thread.Sleep(50)` polling of a volatile flag. Late days are

then not skipped. P-RC7 confirms that callbacks arrive while the calc thread sleeps. Log `OF tick chunk wait day(..) ms(..) ready(True|False)`. In wait mode the strategy also counts each closed bar's `FlowSource` per session (`SessionSourceTally`, lazy, per pass, under `m_flowLock`) and logs one Info line per session when the session changes, the last one in `StopCalc`: `OF tick source session(yyyy-MM-dd) bars(n) quote(q) tickRule(t) mcBidAsk(m) aggressor(a) barUpDown(b) unavailable(u)`. Each session is reported once per pass (deduped), so a session that stays all-Quote (`tickRule(0)`) leaves a trace. No new `[Input]`.

5.3 Callback (`onFlowData` 844–865)

- Look up the chunk from `State`.
- Copy `result.Data` once into a local array inside its own `try`. Iterate under `m_flowLock` as today, but only after the chunk is releasable.
- On `IsCompleted`, set the chunk to Done and record the count.
- **Errors are per chunk.** The `catch` marks only that (day, stream) Failed and queues `OF tick chunk failed ...`. If `TickChunkSplitOnFail > 0` and this was the first attempt, the scheduler re-plans that day as N equal sub-windows (default 4 × 6 h), issued by the pump. Otherwise the day stays Failed and the next day continues.
- **The tick gate (910) becomes per bar.** A bar uses `TickStream` iff the chunks covering its close time are Done for Trade (and Bid/Ask when quotes are on). Otherwise it uses `BarsOnly`, so a failed day falls back to the bar tiers. Replace `m_flowHistoryDone[0]` with `m_chunks.ReadyAt(CloseTime)`. `onFlowData` keeps setting `m_flowHistoryDone[stream]` for the last chunk only, which keeps the RT semantics.
- **Memory guard.** When `TickChunkLate == Skip`, the callback drops the ticks of a chunk whose window ends at or before the last closed bar (volatile snapshot) instead of queuing them. They are counted as `late`.

5.4 Diag lines (Info per chunk; Journal for the plan, failures and the summary)

```
Journal  OF tick chunk plan days(D) streams(Trade,Bid,Ask) first(yyyy-MM-dd) last(..) zone(Exchange) boundaryEt(17:00) maxInFlightDays(1) waitMs(0) late(Skip)
Info     OF tick chunk start day(yyyy-MM-dd) stream(Bid) from(yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm) to(..) rt(False) attempt(1)
Info     OF tick chunk done day(..) stream(..) ticks(n) ms(t)
Info     OF tick chunk skipped day(..) reason(late|closedDay)
Info     OF tick source session(yyyy-MM-dd) bars(n) quote(q) tickRule(t) mcBidAsk(m) aggressor(a) barUpDown(b) unavailable(u)   (wait mode only; once per session per pass)
Journal  OF tick chunk failed day(..) stream(..) attempt(a) exception(<FullName>) message(..) action(split4|giveUp)
Journal  OF tick chunk summary done(x) failed(y) skipped(z) ticks(n) lateDropped(m)      (once, when nothing is pending, or in StopCalc)
```

5.5 Config (all on the protected `FlowCfg`; no `[Input]`; set by the derived strategy as today)

Field	Default	Meaning
`McRecalcOnLoad`	`true`	Fix 1 trigger on/off
`McRecalcMax`	`1`	recalcs per cache signature (loop guard)
`McIdlePollMs`	`1000`	`RecalcLastBarAfter` interval while idle work is pending
`McIdleTimeoutSec`	`900`	stop polling after this
`McRecalcFromCallback`	`false`	fallback §4.3 step 6 (the probe decides)
`TickChunkByDay`	`true`	`false` = legacy single request (for A/B only)
`TickChunkMaxInFlightDays`	`1`	1..4
`TickChunkSplitOnFail`	`4`	sub-windows for a failed day; 0 = no retry
`TickChunkLate`	`Skip`	typed enum `ETickChunkLate { Skip, Load }`

Field	Default	Meaning
`TickChunkWaitMs`	`0`	bounded per-day wait in CalcBar; 0 = off
`TickChunkBoundaryEt`	`17:00`	chunk boundary (ET)

6. Threading rules (all from §2)

1. MC calls (`ExecControl.*`, `DataLoader.BeginLoadData/EndLoadData`, `Bars`, `trace`, `engineSink`) run only in `CalcBar`, `StartCalc` (no trace there), `StopCalc` and `OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent` (P-RC3: calc thread). The only exceptions are `McRecalcFromCallback` and the existing `EndLoadData` paths. - `StopCalc` runs on the UI thread (probe). It ends loads (`EndLoadData`) and drains the queue, but reads no `Bars`/`Output`: `_CustomSignal.trace()` checks the thread and, off the calc thread, stamps the bar time, symbol and zone cached by `noteCalcThread()` (called first in `CalcBar` and `OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent`) and writes no `Output`.
2. Callbacks touch only `m_flow`, `m_mcCache` and scheduler state under `m_flowLock`, plus the queue under `m_flowQueueLock`.
3. `Recalculate()` is the last statement on its path and is never wrapped in a catch-all.
4. Don't catch exceptions around `base.*` calls (MC's MaxBarsBack restart).

7. Code issues found (flag to Ettienne; fix in this PR unless noted)

7.1 `chartType(Regular)` on the "FootPrint" request (696)

- When `McBidAskChartType == FootPrint`, line 684 builds `Resolution.CreateFootPrint(...)` and logs `res.ChartType`, which reads **Regular**.
- The request does work: run B returned `data2Bars(61837) levels(479517)`. So `CreateFootPrint` carries the footprint mode in other `Resolution` members (the stubs hint at a delta-type member), and `ChartType` stays `Regular`.
- The line is misleading, and so is `chartType(FootPrint)` in the `loaded` line (822), because that one prints the config value rather than the request.
- **Fix:** log `builder(CreateFootPrint delta(ASK_TRADE_BID_TRADE) footprint(BID_ASK_VOL) pct(False)) resChartType(Regular)` from the typed enum values passed in. Once the dump (§8) names the footprint members, log them typed as well.
- No behaviour change. P-RC8 (dump) answered this: after `CreateFootPrint`, `ChartType = Regular`, `DeltaType = None` and `HaveDelta = True`, and `Size` is `UInt32`. `Regular` is therefore expected. The footprint mode shows in `HaveDelta`, so log `haveDelta(..)` typed next to `resChartType(..)`.

7.2 `To = Now+1d` (663, 689)

This loads 6 weeks of data past the chart end, and it is a direct contributor to the array overflow. Fixed by §4.5.

7.3 Backlog bug in `FlowEngine.CloseBar` (301–319). This must be fixed in commit 2, because chunking makes late arrival normal.

- `CloseBar` pops **every** queued trade with `Time <= CloseTime`. When history arrives after bars have already closed as `BarsOnly`, the first `TickStream` bar absorbs all the earlier ticks into one giant footprint. With `McBidAsk = Prefer`, that bar's MC set then fails the volume check (`volMismatch`, 251), and the garbage footprint stays tagged Quote/High.
- The first bar also absorbs the extra day of ticks from `from = first − 1 day` (654).
- **Fix (MC-free):** the engine remembers `m_lastClose`, the previous `CloseBar`'s CloseTime. Trades with `Time <= m_lastClose` are popped and **not added**; count them in a new `fp.BacklogDropped` / `BacklogTrades` counter. The first bar uses `CloseTime − bar duration`, passed as a new `BarInput.OpenTime`.
- **Which charts get the `OpenTime` cut (P-RC-EResolution, answered).** Only **exact time-based** Regular charts: a typed `switch` on `EResolution` maps `Second`, `Minute`, `Hour` and `Day` to a unit of 1 s / 1 m / 1 h / 1 d, and the bar length is `Size × unit` (`_OrderFlow.ExactBarLength`). `Week`, `Month`, `Quarter` and `Year` are calendar-aligned, so they are **not** cut by length; they stay on the non-time path (previous-close cut only), logged once at Info (`OF tick backlog calendar resolution type() size()`

`-> no OpenTime cut`). Every other member (Tick, Volume, Points, Change, OrigPoints, PointAndFigure, Kagi, LineBreak, Renko, HeikinAshi, FootPrint, CumDelta, Unknown, all Custom*) and every non-Regular chart type stays non-time, as before. `Duration()` is not used for the decision. Source: Ettienne's `EResolution` dump (his MC install, 2026-11-01 15:56): Unknown=0, Tick=1, Minute=2, Hour=3, Day=4, Week=5, Month=6, Year=7, Volume=8, Second=9, Quarter=10, Points=11, Change=12, OrigPoints=13, PointAndFigure=14, Kagi=15, LineBreak=16, Renko=17, HeikinAshi=18, FootPrint=19, CumDelta=20, Custom*=1001..1013; `new Resolution(e, 1).Duration()` is non-zero only for Second 1 s, Minute 1 m, Hour 1 h, Day 1 d, Week 7 d, Month 30 d, Quarter 91 d, Year 365 d (0 for all others, Custom* included); the chart check Regular/Minute/Size 1 gave 00:01:00. (This replaces the interim Minute/Day-only rule.)
- The quote queues already only advance state (287–291), so nothing changes there.

7.4 MaxBars 5000 (80, 353–359)

- The 19072-bar run drops the oldest footprints from bar 5051.
- CumDelta is **not** actually truncated with `ResetMode.Session` on 1-min ES (a reset period is ≤ ~1380 bars, which is less than 5000). Only ladder/footprint lookups more than 5000 bars back return null, and the warning text overstates this.
- **Out of scope.** Proposal for later: `MaxBars = 0` means auto = `max(5000, 2 × bars per reset period)`. Do not scale with the loaded range, because footprint memory is roughly 2–5 KB per bar.
- Trivial wording fix allowed in this PR: "…; CumDelta is Truncated only if a reset period exceeds the cap".

7.5 Smaller items

- **Separate PR, not this one (done in the typed-enums follow-up to #79: `enqueueTick` now reads `b.Time`, `b.Close`, `(double)b.TotalVolume`; `tickBarMember` removed).** `_CustomSignal.Strategy.CS` 1292–1310 (`M-TICK enqueueTick/tickBarMember`) reads `Bar` members **by reflection with member-name strings** ("Time", "Close", "TotalVolume"). That breaks the hard rule. Use the typed `b.Time`, `b.Close`, `(double)b.TotalVolume`, as `flowTick` 869–875 already does.
- **FYI.** `_VolumeProfileStatistics.Indicator.CS` 357 wraps `Recalculate()` in `catch { }`, which may swallow MC's unwind (§2).
- `startOrderFlow` (618) resets `m_mcResult`/counters while a callback of the previous pass may still be running. This is harmless once the cache is the source of truth, but keep the callback's `m_flow == null` check (763).
- The stubs (`McStubs.cs` 36–37, 57) need `ICalculationControl.Recalculate()`, `DataRequest.CreateFromTo`, `InstrumentDataRequest.TimeZone` and `IFullSymbolData.Count` for `tools/sem` compile checks.

8. API points: the two one-off files (P-RC1..P-RC9 answered)

The files are saved as `/workspace/specs/_McRecalcProbe.Strategy.CS` (signal) and `/workspace/specs/_McApiDump2.Indicator.CS` (indicator). Import both into the PowerLanguage .NET Editor and compile. - Put `_McApiDump2` on any @ES chart and copy the Output window. - Put `_McRecalcProbe` alone on a historical @ES 1-min chart (the 9a setup), wait about 30 s, remove it, and send `%TEMP%\McRecalcProbe.csv`.

ID	Question	Answered by
P-RC1	Same object instance (`obj`) and instance fields kept across `Recalculate`?	**Answered (probe):** yes. `obj(719710)` on both passes; `instRecalcs=1` carried into pass 2. The instance cache and gate are valid; the static guard stays as a backstop.
P-RC2	Does `OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent` fire on a **signal** on a non-real-time chart after the last bar?	**Answered (probe):** yes, about 1.0 s after `RecalcLastBarAfter(1 s)` was armed at the last bar (historical chart, `realTime(False)`, `autoTrading(False)`). Forum t=49867 does not apply to chart backtesting.
P-RC3	Its thread vs CalcBar (`tid`), and are `Bars` readable in it?	**Answered (probe):** the calc thread (tid 60, same as `CalcBar`); `Bars.Time[0]` is readable.
P-RC4	May `Recalculate()` be called from that event, and how does it unwind (exception type)?	**Answered (probe):** it throws `ManagedStudies.details._ELAPI_exception_Wrap_` (MC's unwind); `StopCalc` and then `StartCalc` of pass 2 follow at once.

ID	Question	Answered by
		It must propagate: last statement, never caught. Derived code after `base.CalcBar()` does not run on that path; `RecalcPending` stays for it.
P-RC5	`DataRequest` members (`CreateFromTo`, `To`, `ToAlwaysIsNow`, `Count`); which wins, `Range` or `From`/`To`?	**Answered (dump):** `DataRequest` is a struct with `CreateFromTo`/`CreateDaysBack`/`CreateBarsBack` and the fields `RequestType`, `Count`, `From`, `To`, `ToAlwaysIsNow`. `InstrumentDataRequest` has `From`/`To` properties and a field `DataRequest Range`. Set both (§5.2). The request line's logged window shows which one MC used.
P-RC6	`InstrumentDataRequest.TimeZone` exists and is copied by `Bars.Request`; `FullSymbolData.Time[Current−Count]` = last bar	**Answered (dump):** `InstrumentDataRequest` has a field `RequestTimeZone TimeZone` (`Local`, `GMT`, `Exchange`). It is a struct field, so `Bars.Request` copies it. The run's logged first/last bar line checks the last-bar index.
P-RC7	Do callbacks arrive while CalcBar sleeps (bounded wait)?	**Answered (probe):** yes. A DataLoader callback (tid 61) arrived while `CalcBar` slept in the wait loop (done in 52 ms). `TickChunkWaitMs` stays.
P-RC8	`Resolution` members after `CreateFootPrint` (why `ChartType` = Regular) and the `Size` type	**Answered (dump):** after `CreateFootPrint`, `ChartType = Regular`, `DeltaType = None`, `HaveDelta = True`; `Size` is `UInt32`. `Regular` is expected (§7.1).
P-RC9	`ICalculationControl` members and the virtual hooks on the SignalObject base chain	**Answered (dump):** `ICalculationControl` has `Abort()`, `Recalculate()` and `RecalcLastBarAfter(TimeSpan)`. `CStudyAbstract` has `virtual OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent()`.

Decision table: if P-RC2 or P-RC3 fails, set `McRecalcFromCallback = true` as the default and enable the direct-write log path. If P-RC7 fails, remove `TickChunkWaitMs`. If P-RC5 shows that `From`/`To` win, keep setting both (harmless). **Outcome:** P-RC2, P-RC3 and P-RC7 passed, so `McRecalcFromCallback` stays `false` and `TickChunkWaitMs` stays. The probe also showed that `StopCalc` runs on the UI thread (tid 1); see §6 rule 1.

P-RC-EResolution: answered by Ettienne's `EResolution` dump (2026-11-01 15:56). Exact time-based = Regular `Second`/`Minute`/`Hour`/`Day` (bar length `Size × unit`); `Week`/`Month`/`Quarter`/`Year` are calendar-aligned and stay on the non-time fallback (logged once at Info); all other members are non-time. Details in §7.3.

Probe source (the dump is in the file):

```
// (abridged; full file /workspace/specs/_McRecalcProbe.Strategy.CS)
protected override void StartCalc() { m_pass++; m_bars = 0; m_armed = false; log("StartCalc"); }
protected override void CalcBar() {
  m_bars++;
  if (m_bars == 1) { /* log Current, Count, Time[Current-Count], Bars.Request.TimeZone; pass 1: BeginLoadData with
                        Range = DataRequest.CreateFromTo(last-2d, last), then Sleep(50)-wait up to 20 s for the callback */ }
  if (Bars.LastBarOnChart && Bars.Status == EBarState.Close && !m_armed) { m_armed = true; ExecControl.RecalcLastBarAfter(TimeSpan.FromSeconds(1)); }
}
protected override void OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent() {
  log("OnRecalcLastBarAfterEvent");                    // every log line carries tid, obj, pass, instRecalcs, staticRecalcs
  try { log("Bars.Time[0](" + Bars.Time[0] + ")"); } catch (Exception ex) { log("Bars exception " + ex.GetType().FullName); }
  if (m_pass == 1 && s_recalcs == 0 && m_recalcs == 0) { s_recalcs++; m_recalcs++;
    try { ExecControl.Recalculate(); } catch (Exception ex) { log("Recalculate threw " + ex.GetType().FullName); throw; }
    log("returned from Recalculate"); }
}
```

9. Tests

Off-MC unit tests (`tests/OrderFlowTests/Program.cs`, C# 7.3, run with `run.sh`): - `McLevelCache`: Add/Covers/ReplayInto produce the same `CloseBar` result as direct `AddMcLevels`. - `Clear` on a signature change. - `McRecalcGate`: - `Wait` before historyDone. - `SkipNoMissed` when no misses; `Recalc` once; `SkipGuard` on the second call with the same signature. - `SkipAutoTrading`; `SkipDisabled`. - Gate reset (AB1–AB12): A → B → A allows a recalc for the fresh A (also when B completed with no level set); a same-signature repeat is still `SkipGuard` at `McRecalcMax`; an A ↔ B alternation still trips the process guard at 3 per key per 600 s; the skip-line format; `Forget` keeps `Pass`; strategy wiring (source checks). - Bar total / volume basis (VB1–VB9, BU1–BU3, DG1–DG6): Ticks total matches ask + bid; the old up-volume feed is a `volMismatch`; McAsk/McBid kept; TickCount → `reason(volumeBasis)` with one Info line, no Warning, no exception; Trade Volume passes; Up + Down vs Ticks (unchanged volume → Unavailable); an all-down bar is not empty; the diag picker limits and line format; strategy wiring (source checks). - `SessionSourceTally` (SS1–SS7): one line per finished session, the open session on `Flush`, deduped, every source counted; strategy wiring (wait mode only, Info, StopCalc flush). - `PlanGlobexDays`: Sep 1–18 2026 gives 14 Globex days (Sep 7 Labor Day trades with an early halt; the log has `session(2026-09-07) bars(1139)`). Monday starts Sunday 17:00 ET. Windows are contiguous and non-overlapping. - `TickChunkScheduler`: - in-order release with MaxInFlight 1 and 3 (out-of-order completion); - Failed → split into 4 → Done; - Skip-late; last chunk RT; - `ReadyAt`. - Backlog fix: ticks pushed after 3 BarsOnly bars are not added to bar 4; the counter equals their count; bar 4 contains only its own ticks.

`tests/SessionClockTests`: `FromEastern(ToEastern(t)) == t` across both DST changes for Exchange/Central and Local zones.

Live acceptance (Ettienne runs, Analyst checks the log): - **A1, Fix 1 (9a rerun, @ES 1-min, Aug 31 → Sep 18, McBidAsk = Prefer; Format Instrument > Settings > Build Volume On = Trade Volume)**: - exactly one `OF McBidAsk diag request` line in pass 1; - one `cache stored`; - exactly one `recalc triggered`; - a second `RUN id(..)` followed by `cache hit ... request(none)` and `recalc pass using cache`; - **no** further `diag request` line and no second `recalc triggered`; - `OF T9 session(..) mcCover(> 0)` for every session inside the loaded window, expected ≈ 100% except `volMismatch` bars; - no `OF tier McBidAsk->Unavailable reason(volMismatch)` on a full session; the `OF McBidAsk diag vol` lines show `ticks(..)` ≈ `mcSum(..)` and `volume(..)` ≈ `up(..)` (up volume only). If `mcSum` still differs from `ticks`, send the lines before the VWAP/VP volume-basis PR; - on Tick Count instead: `OF McBidAsk Unavailable reason(volumeBasis)` once at Info only if the strategy states `FlowCfg.BuildVolumeOn = TickCount` (not detected yet; run `_McApiDump4` with each setting and send both outputs); - the `diag stop` / chunk summary lines appear **without** removing the study (idle drain). - **A2, Fix 2 (same chart, Sep 1–18)**: - no `Array dimensions exceeded` anywhere; - one `tick chunk plan`; - per-chunk `start`/`done` (or `skipped reason(late)`) lines; - a `summary` with `failed(0)`. - **A3, Fix 2 wait mode (`TickChunkWaitMs = 120000`, McBidAsk = Off)**: - every day `done`; - Quote/TickRule bars present in sessions (the quality line shows source Quote; one `tick source session(..)` line per session); - no bar with a backlog footprint (`BacklogDropped` journaled only if > 0). - **A4, regression**: with `McBidAsk = Off`, `TickChunkByDay = false`, the run behaves like 33a51bf, except for the clamp and the backlog fix. - **A5, loop guard**: in a `McRecalcMax = 1` run, press Recalculate manually after A1. The result must be `cache hit`, no request, and no recalc. - **A6, A → B → A** (Live Check 9a rerun): load A (recalc), switch the chart to B, then back to A. The A line must be `cache miss reason(signature) .. recalcGate(reset)` followed by `recalc triggered`, not `recalc skipped reason(guard)`. With Trade Volume, A's sessions after the recalc show `mcCover` ≈ 100% (no `reason(volMismatch)` tier line), and each pass logs its own first 10 `diag vol` lines.